

Chapter 5: Photosynthesis

5.1 Introduction

Photosynthesis is the process by which green plants use sunlight to synthesise food from carbon dioxide and water. Chlorophyll, the green pigment in leaves, absorbs light energy. The overall reaction can be written as a balanced chemical equation.

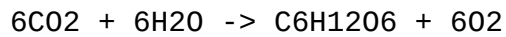
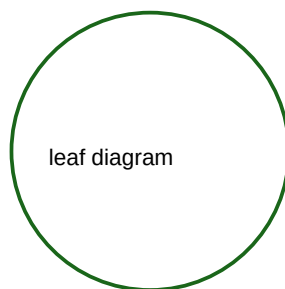


Table 5.1 Rate of photosynthesis

Light intensity	Temperature	Rate observed
Low	25 C	Slow
Medium	25 C	Moderate
High	25 C	Rapid



Q1. Define photosynthesis in your own words.

Q2. Name the pigment involved in this process.